

Parsing OOXML in Rust

Lessons from converting 40M documents a month

The 80/20 of DOCX

- A handful of elements dominate real documents: paragraphs, runs, tables, numbering.
- The long tail (SmartArt, OMMML, VML) is where parsers go to die.
- Ship the core, degrade gracefully on the tail — and log everything you skip.

```
match element {  
  b"w:p" => blocks.push(parse_paragraph(r)?),  
  b"w:tbl" => blocks.push(parse_table(r)?),  
  other => warn!(?other, "skipped unsupported element"),  
}
```